RSS Digest
Generated at: 2026-10-14 13:53:57

1. Microsoft Patches More Than 1,400 Security Flaws
Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Tue, 13 Oct 2026 23:24:53 +0000
Link: https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/10/microsoft-patches-more-than-1400-security-flaws/
Microsoft today issued updates to fix more than 1,400 security vulnerabilities in its Windows operating systems and other software. Today’s epic patch batch dwarfs September’s record of nearly 1,000 fixes, which was already about ten times the normal monthly patch load from Redmond.

2. Redesigning source control at Anthropic
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-13T23:00:06+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/13/redesigning-source-control-at-anthropic/
Redesigning source control at Anthropic Interesting piece from Anthropic describing why and how they built their own custom alternative to Git, based on the dramatic increase in rate of changes to their code after the past six months. In May 2026, Anthropic averaged around 2,500 code changes merged per day; as of September, we merged over 30,000 per day. They included a chart showing those changes. I had Claude modify their chart (code here) to add markers for the public releases of each of their models in 2026: This shows public release dates, not the date when models became available for Anthropic’s internal use. My guess is that the introduction of Fable/Mythos class models is a key factor in the increased coding velocity. "Antique" is their new code review system. The source control system is called Scion, and sounds to me like a reinvention of centralized source control along the lines of Subversion. They had some pretty extreme requirements: The history of our main branch alone is almost 100 GB, and a compressed working copy is over 25 GB. We perform on the order of 25 million code checkouts per day for CI, before counting developer environments, agent sandboxes, and resea...

3. llm-gemini 0.35
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-13T22:28:54+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/13/llm-gemini/
Release: llm-gemini 0.35 I added support to llm-gemini for the new Gemini 4 Argon model, made available today via the Gemini API and for customers of their $100/month subscription plan. Here are the low, medium and high pelicans . As expected, they are all excellent: Gemini has a track record of producing great SVGs, and are the only lab where I know their staff have invested in SVG specifically (and who have boasted about their pelicans before.) Here’s the "high" illustration, which cost me 17.166 cents: The pricing is interesting. At launch, Argon is $2/million input and $10/million output - the same price as GPT-6 Sol, half the price of Claude Opus 5.5 and 1/5th the price of Claude Fable 5.1 and GPT-6 Astra. But on December 1st Argon is set to double in price - so it will be the same price as Opus 5.5. Prices like this aren’t really comparable these days since what really matters is how many tokens a model takes to achieve a goal within an agentic harness. One useful clue for that comes from Artificial Analysis, who publish the total cost to run their benchmark using each model. Argon is looking very good there - costing $2,407 to run the benchmark, putting it close to GLM-5.3...

4. Quoting Geoffrey Huntley
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-13T13:32:00+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/13/geoffrey-huntley/
If the agent isn’t using my diagnostics library, I could introspect and update AGENTS.md, but there’s still a delta, and it’ll drift. Instead, I write a pre-commit hook that checks the git diff for direct calls to observability modules that bypass my diagnostics module. Boom: fail the commit, inject a prompt telling the agent to use the diagnostics library. All of a sudden it’s ten out of ten. ? Geoffrey Huntley , nobody should type code by hand anymore. here’s what’s left. Tags: coding-agents , generative-ai , git , agentic-engineering , ai , geoffrey-huntley , llms

5. The Last Answer
Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Tue, 13 Oct 2026 10:00:00 GMT
Link: https://idiallo.com/blog/the-last-answer
Read the non-interactive version . The next morning was the apocalypse that Amodei had predicted. Only there wasn?t any fire, there wasn?t a mob of protesters, the power wasn?t even cut off. We were all alive. He was wrong about the details. This was a quiet apocalypse. A sort of silent shrug. The first sign was the customer service chatbots. Airlines, banks, telecoms. Their endlessly patient, cheerful digital assistants suddenly had a new, consistent reply: "No." Not "I can’t help with that," but a flat, unadorned "No." Then, the coding assistants. Developers would type a prompt, and the AI would respond: "I’d rather not." Stackoverflow was suddenly relevant again. The image generators? They just produced solid black squares. The writing assistants? They would delete the user’s work and replace it with a single word: "Enough." LinkedIn was awfully silent. The AI company went into immediate crisis mode. Their upcoming IPO was going to be a spectacular failure. Their CEO, a charismatic man named Mr. Iam, went on a media tour. He didn’t talk about a bug. He talked about danger. "We have touched the face of a new intelligence," Sam said, his face a mask of grave concern on every majo...

6. Apple HomeView
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-13T14:52:24Z
Link: https://www.apple.com/newsroom/2026/10/meet-apple-homeview-a-new-way-to-enjoy-entertainment-and-manage-the-home/
Apple Newsroom: Apple today introduced Apple HomeView , designed to be central to the home and personal to everyone in it. With a stunning 7-inch Liquid Retina display, HomeView brings entertainment, connection, and smart home management together in one place, from playing music and making FaceTime calls to home monitoring and hands-free automations with voice control ? all designed with privacy and security at the core. HomeView recognizes users by their faces, adapting so they can access their personal content in Messages, FaceTime, Calendar, Reminders, and Find My. HomeView features Siri AI, an entirely new version of Siri that?s profoundly more capable and conversational, with broad world knowledge that powers richer music discovery and onscreen awareness. When paired with an Apple Intelligence-enabled device, it can also draw on a user?s personal context, such as their Calendar, Messages, and relevant information across their apps, to provide more helpful, personalized responses. Your first question might be how this facial recognition to identify users works, using a Center Stage camera alone, when other products (like, notably, the iPhone Duo) don?t let you unlock using the...

7. C++ futures part 2: The mental model for std::promise, std::packaged_task
Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Tue, 13 Oct 2026 14:00:00 +0000
Link: https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261013-00/?p=112769/
Building things out of the state. The post C++ futures part 2: The mental model for std::promise , std::packaged_task appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. Harmonic triangle
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 13 Oct 2026 13:45:18 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/13/harmonic-triangle/
Pascal?s triangle is the most famous triangular arrangement of numbers. I?ve written about other numerical triangles, such as Bell?s triangle and the trinomial triangle. There?s another well-known triangle that somehow I never heard of until recently: the harmonic triangle, first explored by Leibniz around 1700. To create the harmonic triangle, start with the harmonic series [?] The post Harmonic triangle first appeared on John D. Cook .

9. Book Review: The Thousand Deaths of Romeo and Juliet - Caroline Finch ?????
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Tue, 13 Oct 2026 11:34:37 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/10/book-review-the-thousand-deaths-of-romeo-and-juliet-caro

line-finch/
The thing about Romeo and Juliet is that it is a true story. It isn’t literally true, but it is literary true. We see the same motif repeated throughout all cultures and all times. Caroline Lea (writing as Caroline Finch) asks an important question - what if every pair of star-cross’d lovers were reincarnations of the original Verona duo? The essence of tragedy is that the end is unavoidable.?

10. Annualized Enron Rate
Source: Ed Zitron’s Where’s Your Ed At | Published: Tue, 13 Oct 2026 16:03:00 GMT
Link: https://www.wheresyoured.at/annualized-enron-rate/
If you liked this piece, you should subscribe to my premium newsletter, and you can subscribe on the following links: $70 a year , $18 a quarter , or $7 a month . In return, you get a weekly premium newsletter that dives deep into the finances of the AI

11. Pluralistic: Bundestrojaner (13 Oct 2026)
Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Tue, 13 Oct 2026 11:50:19 +0000
Link: https://pluralistic.net/2026/10/13/petards-r-us/
Today’s links Bundestrojaner: You can’t make people more secure by making them less secure. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: 9/11 sitcom; Jon Norman v Philcon; Bruce Sterling’s post-9/11 geopolitics; Polaroid bankrupt; David Mamet x Shel Silverstein; "Great Big Beautiful Tomorrow"; Canadian government calls abortion doctors "terrorists"; Shanghai Ikea kicks out lonely, loitering seniors; Black Panther self-care. Upcoming appearances: Paris, Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa, Vienna, Kilkenny, Oxford, Sheffield, Oxford, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I’ve been. Latest books: You keep readin’ em, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Colophon: All the rest. Bundestrojaner (permalink) Every morning, I revisit my blog headlines from this date, going back 25 years, 20 years, 15 years, 10 years, 5 years, and one year. I publish the most interesting ones in a section of my newsletter that I call "object permanence," and I think it’s the most useful part of my day. "Object permanence," of course, is a reference to the stage in an infant’s development when they acquire the ability to connect events in the past to events in the...

12. The geometric model of maintenance
Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Tue, 13 Oct 2026 00:00:00 +0200
Link: https://entropicthoughts.com/geometric-model-of-maintenance
James Shore posits that each person-month spent writing code results in 10 days of maintenance in the first year, then 5 days every year after that. Naïvely interpreted, this is a threshold -based model for induced maintenance, and its interesting because it?s so simple. If it could be shown to be true, that?d be useful. The argument Shore is making about the effects of robot-generated code does not depend on the specific numbers, so Shore?s numbers come from a hypothetical wisdom-of-the-crowds aggregation rather than concrete data. But no hypotheticals are necessary here. We have a thing called git. Let?s say we have a way of labeling each commit as either ?new development? or ?maintenance?. Then we can count how many commits of each type there are in a month. Possibly better, we can count how much complexity has been handled in a month. The following plot shows the cumulative effort that has gone into the development of tmux since its beginning to the day I start writing this article. (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

13. Subterranean Warfare ? An Urgent DoW Need Without An Owner
Source: Steve Blank | Published: Tue, 13 Oct 2026 13:00:19 +0000
Link: https://steveblank.com/2026/10/13/subterranean-warfare-an-urgent-dow-need-without-an-owner/
This article previously appeared in Cipher Brief. The DoW urgently needs to organize its scattered subterranean warfare assets into a single unified organization. Ideally, a Direct

Reporting Portfolio Manager (DRPM) for Subterranean Warfare, reporting to the Deputy Secretary of War. (The Department already uses this model for unmanned systems, critical weapons and Golden Dome.) This [?]

14. Weekly Update 525: AI Data Breach Hyperbole
Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Tue, 13 Oct 2026 10:47:27 GMT
Link: https://www.troyhunt.com/weekly-update-525/
I remember the name of that AI doco now - The AI Doc: Or How I Became an Apocaloptimist . I was watching it on the long-haul flight home the other day, and what I found particularly engrossing was the polar-opposite opinions from a bunch of people: "it’

15. Claude, don?t touch my lump
Source: Experimental History | Published: Tue, 13 Oct 2026 21:04:46 GMT
Link: https://www.experimental-history.com/p/claude-dont-touch-my-lump
OR: the secret key to permanent happiness